Make a Career Visit Count

A FIELD GUIDE FOR PROFESSIONAL CONVERSATIONS & WORKPLACE DISCOVERY

A good career experience should help you answer a real question about a profession—not simply introduce you to someone with an impressive job title. Use this short guide to prepare, learn, and follow through.

Before the experience

- Choose one decision you are trying to make: Does this field suit my interests, skills, and priorities?
- Research the profession and the host organization; prepare three questions you cannot answer easily online.
- Confirm arrival instructions, accessibility or religious accommodation needs, dress and safety requirements, and photography rules.

During the experience

- Ask what an ordinary week looks like, what skills matter, and what is less visible from the outside.
- Look at how people collaborate and make decisions, not just what their final product looks like.
- Respect confidentiality, site policies, and time limits. Never photograph work, clients, or equipment without explicit permission.

Questions worth asking

- Which tasks take the most time, and what problems are most difficult?
- What surprised you most after entering this profession?
- If you were exploring this field today, what low-cost first step would you recommend?
- What alternative roles use similar skills but have a different daily experience?

After the experience

- Write down three things you learned and one assumption that changed.
- Decide on a concrete next action, such as a course, informational interview, portfolio experiment, or further visit.
- Send a concise thank-you note directly to the host using your own words.

This guide is educational. Participation in a workplace visit requires host approval and compliance with applicable safety, confidentiality, and access rules.